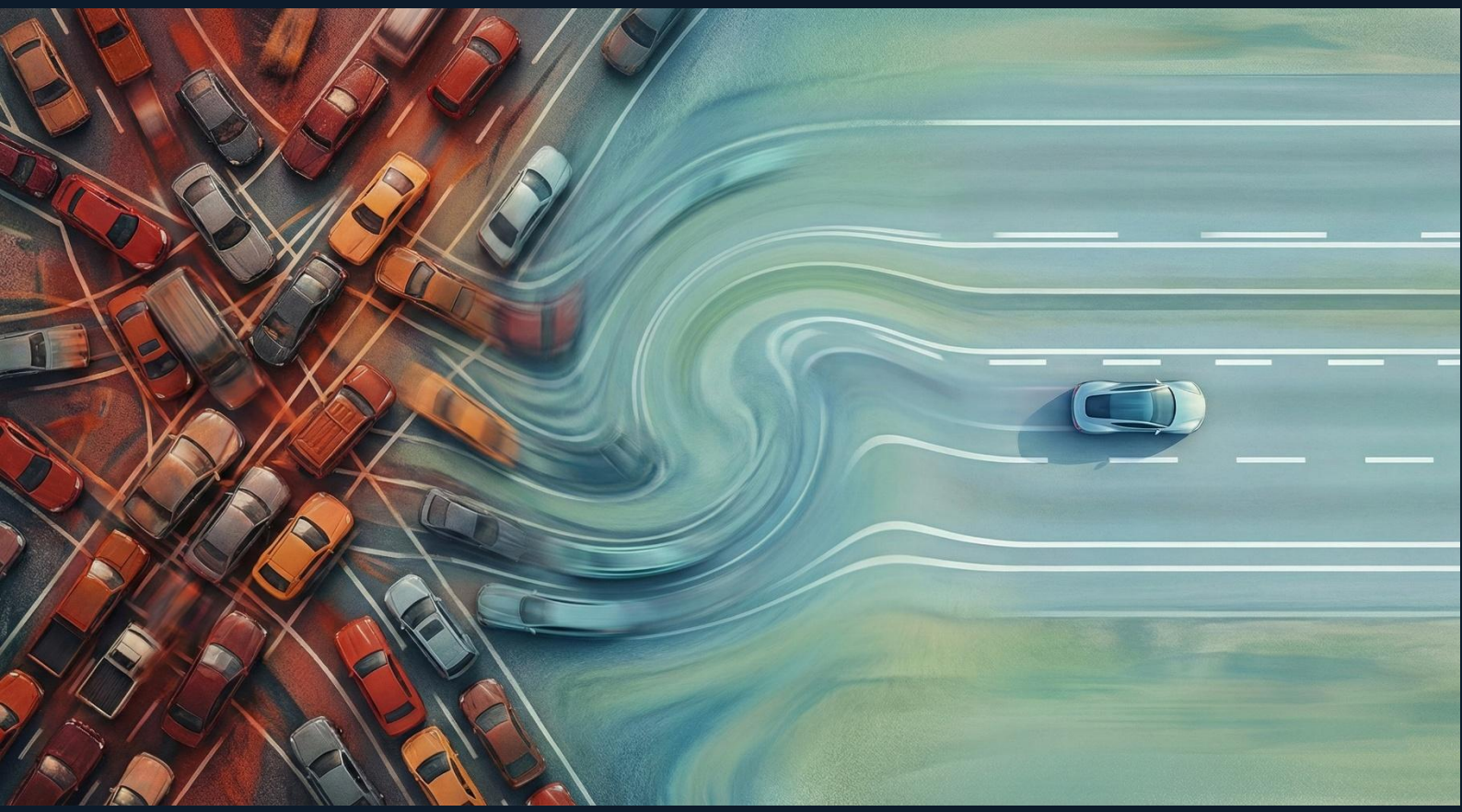
5 PRACTICAL AUTOMATIONS YOU CAN SET UP RIGHT NOW

…to reclaim hours of your time money can't buy.



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What’s Inside This Guide

A concise overview of what you’ll take away:

- **Five practical automations you can implement immediately**
- **Clear, step-by-step instructions for each setup**
- **Familiar tools (Zapier, Gmail, Xero, Calendly, Google Sheets)**
- **A simple “first step this week” for each automation**
- **Direct, tactical advice—no filler, no theory**

Introduction

Most business owners lose multiple hours each week to repetitive admin—the kind of work that doesn't grow your business but quietly consumes your time.

This guide gives you five high-impact automations you can implement this week. Each one is simple enough to set up quickly, yet powerful enough to permanently reduce your workload.

About me

I work with small and mid-sized business owners to eliminate unnecessary manual work through straightforward automation. No coding, no technical jargon—just practical systems that measurably save time.

1. Lead Capture → CRM + Instant Follow-Up

Estimated time saved: ~2 hours/week

Problem

Website leads sit unprocessed until you manually add them to your CRM. By the time you reply, many have moved on.

Solution

Connect your website form directly to your CRM. Each submission automatically becomes a new contact, and a personalised acknowledgement email goes out immediately.

How to Set It Up

Export recent form submissions

Note which fields you transfer manually

Create a new Zap: Trigger: new form submission

Action: create CRM contact

Action: send follow-up email using Gmail / Outlook / MailChimp

Test

Activate

Start Here This Week

Build a simple Zap using just name + email.

2. Automated Invoice Payment Reminders

Estimated time saved: ~1.5 hours/week

Problem

Manually checking outstanding invoices and sending reminders is slow, repetitive, and often uncomfortable.

Solution

Use native Xero or QuickBooks reminder sequences—or trigger reminders using Zapier—to automate the entire cycle.

How to Set It Up

Xero → Settings → Automation → Invoice Reminders

Enable the default reminder sequence

Adjust the message to fit your tone

Activate

Start Here This Week

Turn on the built-in reminders (takes under 15 minutes).

3. Email Inbox Triage + Draft Responses

Estimated time saved: ~4 hours/week

Problem

Your inbox receives the same categories of questions repeatedly, requiring custom replies each time.

Solution

Use Gmail filters to categorise emails, then have Zapier draft predictable responses for you to review and send.

How to Set It Up

Identify your five most frequent email types

Create Gmail labels for each

Build a Zap: Trigger: new email with label

Action: draft suggested reply

Review → refine → send

Start Here This Week

Automate draft replies for one category only.

4. Appointment + Scheduling Automation

Estimated time saved: ~1.5 hours/week

Problem

Back-and-forth scheduling is inefficient and error-prone.

Solution

Use Calendly to manage availability, bookings, and reminders automatically.

How to Set It Up

Create a Calendly account

Set availability + meeting types

Add your booking link to your signature

(Optional) Enable buffer times/reminders

Start Here This Week

Publish a single meeting type.

5. Automated Weekly KPI Reports

Estimated time saved: ~2 hours/week

Problem

Manually compiling weekly metrics from multiple systems is slow and error-prone.

Solution

Use Databox or Google Sheets with Zapier/Make to automatically pull key data into a dashboard.

How to Set It Up

Define key weekly KPIs

Create a blank dashboard or Google Sheet

Pull data from one source using Zapier

Repeat for additional sources

Start Here This Week

Automate draft replies for one category only.

Summary

Total time reclaimed: ~11 hours/week.

That’s time you can reinvest into sales, delivery, strategy—or simply breathing room.

Now, I know that even tackling these 5 “easy wins” may seem daunting to some and for others, there just isn’t the time to get them done, but not to worry…

Free 15 Minute Strategy Audit

If you'd like help with any of the recommendations in this guide OR personalised recommendations tailored to your specific needs, you can book a short call where we identify your biggest time drain and outline your first automation.

Booking link: Let's Automate!

No pitches. Just practical advice you can use immediately.